MCP

Title:
Swipe Up!

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AUTHOR'S NOTES
When VAL "swipes up" it causes a physical reaction in NIK that should be repeated whenever the swipe occurs.

The script sometimes calls for VAL to use "TikTok voice," which refers to the robotic female voice that reads on-screen captions within the app.

At the point noted it in the script, it is the author's intent that the performers insert a very recent trending TikTok dance, with two lines of dialogue adjusted by the performers to fit if necessary. It may work without modification, depending on the dance; this section can also be omitted if preferred.

VAL and NIK can be played by actors of any gender.

SWIPE UP!

[Two actors on a bare stage. The only props are a smartphone and virtual reality glasses, which should look like regular glasses with gizmos on the sides so you can still see the actor's eyes.)

VAL: Nik! Nik Nik Nik.

NIK: Sup Val.

VAL: Try these new virtual reality glasses!

NIK: What do they do?

VAL: They put you inside the phone.

NIK: Inside?

VAL: Yeah, now you see what I see.

NIK: Wait, *whose* phone am I going inside?

VAL: Let's try TikTok.

NIK: Why is my head tingling?

VAL: It's working! Let's go!

NIK: Wait… wait… I'm not ready.

[SWIPE UP 1]

VAL: First one… 30 day dance challenge. Day 1.

NIK: [Dancing badly] I'm bad at dancing, so this feels ok…

VAL: And now day 30!

NIK: [Dancing well, but pulled on a string] What is happening to me!!!

VAL: Whoa.

NIK: (*still dancing)* Ok these might need to be adjusted.

VAL: We gotta try another one.

NIK: What's wrong with you Val?

VAL: I love new apps.

NIK: You're addicted to your phone

VAL: And it's great, Nik.

[SWIPE UP 2]

VAL: [*TikTok voice*] This one weird trick makes you look 20% cuter

NIK: I could go for that…

VAL: (*TikTok voice*) All you need to do is vape hot sauce into your eyeballs

NIK: What?? (*vaping hot sauce into their eyeballs, with increasing resistance*) There's… the vape pen… and it smells like tobacco… Oh no… (eyeball one is vaped) Ahhhhhhh!!!!!

VAL: (*TikTok voice*) It hurts less with the other eye

NIK: (V*aping other eye, more screaming*) No it doesn't! Who tried this the first time?

VAL: Does it actually hurt?

NIK: Swipe you d---

[SWIPE UP 3]

VAL: Ok, smash or pass.

NIK: Oh. I'm gucci.

VAL: Ezra Miller

NIK: Wow, I--

VAL: SMASH OR PASS

NIK: Smash! Oh no.

VAL: Johnny Depp.

NIK: I don't like this theme

VAL: (*menacing)* Smash. Or. Pass.

NIK: Fine. Smash. Please give me an easy one—

VAL: -Your mom!

NIK: Pass. I am so sorry mom, I—

VAL: Your dad!

NIK: Smash!

VAL: What the—

NIK: He's a cool dude.

VAL: Jennifer Lopez—

NIK: Finally, an easy one, I will—

VAL: With the body of Ben Affleck—

NIK: PASS. Dammit Val.

VAL: Millie Bobbie Brown.

NIK: Is this legal?

VAL: You're so bad at this.

[SWIPE UP 4]

VAL: (*TikTok voice*) This condiment is so good, you'll want your food to run you over with its car.

NIK: Like that time with the wiener mobile…

VAL: (*TikTok voice*) Here's how we make happy in a jar for $49.99.

NIK: (Strange, hyped voice) For all you Chef Lil S@v@g3 with two ampersands and a three instead of the vowels fans out there, this is What! You've! Been! Waitiiiiing for! My signature special RAT SAUCE is available now. It'll make you screeeeeeammm! When you put it on pizza. (squeals). Tendies (squeals). Ice cream (squeals). Protein bars! (squeals like mad). How'd ya like to have the best tasting meal of your life? Rat sauce is so intense you won't know if it's good. None of my family can describe it! My friends didn't text me back for days after trying it. That's how good it is! And yeah some had nasty poops but this is the best poop of your life! It's so intense! (squeals) RAT SAUCE will overrun you with flavor. Squirt it in your face today and you will be slurping down your dreams tomorrow. That's the Chef Lil S@v@g3 with two ampersands and a three instead of the vowels. We also have it in vape form!

VAL: Ugh.

NIK: (*back to regular voice*) I need… to use the bathroom…

[SWIPE UP 5]

VAL: (*TikTok voice*) Tell us about a day in your weird life

NIK: (*Heavy British accent of some kind*): Right mate, this is what it's like being a bloke who thinks everything smells like poop. I mean everything, from me mum, she's like a big turd, to me mates, nothing but arsefire, to my favorite meal, just a big bowl of butt gruel. Don't even really have a favorite meal to be honest, I try to just have slurpees. If you were in this room with me, I'd say did someone let a big sewer snake out of the rear exit of the brownton zoo? Even my hand (*smells hand*) ah no, that's rank. Gotta smell something else… which never works… my keys (smells keys from pocket) Bucket of brown sauce! That's worse. Maybe the wall… (starts retching) Oh it's really turtle time now… beam me up someone dropped a Shatner… My cat, let me smell you! (reacts) Oh god it's like a madman took a whole caravan of chocolate hostages… working the turd saw morning noon and night (really retching, keeps going too long, then suddenly normal) Well that's a day in the life of Ol' Poopey Pip! Leave a comment for what you want me to smell next.

VAL: Whoa

NIK: Why didn't you swipe.

VAL: I couldn't stop watching. Let's get out of here.

[SWIPE UP 6]

NIK: I need relief.

VAL: Dance to Beyonce like you're a robot.

NIK: I can't!

VAL: Don't make me swipe again.

NIK: [*Robot Beyonce music as he dances – during this sequence N sings a beyonce song of actor's choice.]*

VAL: Now like you had seven energy drinks!

NIK: [*Manic Beyonce music*]

VAL: Dance to Beyonce like you're a potato

NIK: [*Potato Beyonce music*]

VAL: Dance to Beyonce like your best friend

NIK: [*Very bad dancing*]

VAL: Hey!

NIK: [*Even worse dancing*]

VAL: Dance naked to Beyonce

NIK: [*Get a devilish grin, starts to move to disrobe….]*

VAL: No Nik. No no no no—

[SWIPE UP 7 – A trending dance. This portion is optional, but the intention is to add a very recent trending dance from the app. A line can be added to name the dance if necessary, or to describe its features.]

VAL: Oh this is a good one. Brand new.

NIK: I don't know it.

VAL: You're good at it.

NIK: I am good at it!

VAL: Maybe you're getting used to this?

NIK: Being possessed by your phone like a demon? (*dance is peaking*) Not a chance.

VAL: We need to find safe haven in parent twitter

[SWIPE UP 8]

NIK: Ok folks what should I name my kid? (*points as though names are appearing on screen)* Zaylor? Jennifelx? Bruleén? Kaleb! Exclamation point part of the name! Brydock? Tulum? Crabbe Rangoon? That's hubby's favorite food. Cutie Pie? Striker McBatterson? Axe Murder Hellstein? Jort? Big Philip? Small Philip? Just Regular Philip and "Just Regular" is part of the legal name? Leave your idea in the comments AND DO NOT SAY GREG. MY EX WAS NAMED GREG.

VAL: I don't feel safe.

[SWIPE UP 9]

VAL: It's time for your glow up.

NIK: Do what you will.

VAL: Hair glow up.

(*NIK enhances hair*)

VAL: Smile glow up.

(*NIK enhances smile*)

VAL: Face glow up!

(*NIK enhances face. They are starting to crack*.)

VAL: Botox face glow up!

(NIK's face grows perkier)

VAL: Another injection!

(*NIK's face grows perky to a demented degree*)

VAL: You've gone to the gym every day for six months

(*NIK screams like on steroids*)

VAL: Full. Glow up.

(*NIK tries*)

VAL: (like Kylo Ren meme) MORE!

(*NIK tries*)

VAL: MOORRREEE!

(*NIK breaks)*

NIK: I can't do it! This is too much. You are on TikTok too much! What can you possibly be getting out of this? You're wasting your life. Can we not hang out as normal friends??

VAL: I… (*almost admits NIK is right, but regains composure.*) Just one more swipe.

NIK: You're a monster.

VAL: I'm an influencer.

[SWIPE UP 10]

NIK: Well?

VAL: Oh no… we're in.. sad TikTok!

NIK: Huh?

VAL: (*TikTok voice*) Tell us your worst break up story.

NIK: Like, my own?

VAL: (*TikTok voice*) Tell us your worst break up story.

NIK: I don't want tell all these people about that ,Val.

VAL: What people?

NIK: All the people out there, watching.

VAL: (*TikTok* voice) Tell us your—

NIK: Fine. There was… I had a crush. Named G. I finally asked G out. Said yes. I was… over the moon. Last day of school. Whole summer. And G cheated on me.

VAL: Wait… you mean *G?*

NIK: Last summer. Three times.

VAL: But you two… you're still with…

NIK: Not anymore.

VAL: Why didn't you?

NIK: I was going to tell you today. Guess I did. And a lot of other people

[PHONE AWAY]

VAL: I'm sorry. I'm sorry I got carried away.

NIK: You did, Val.

VAL: Sorry, Nik.

NIK: Don't worry about it.

VAL: What would make you feel better?

NIK: There's one thing.

VAL: Anything.

NIK: [*puts headset back on.]* Looking at a bunch of dumb stuff on TikTok.